

Discrimination

Sometimes people make assumptions about others based on who they are, or on the way they look or act. These assumptions, which are usually false, are known as prejudices. When a person treats someone unfairly because of a prejudice, it is called discrimination.

What is discrimination?

Discrimination can include insulting a person, bullying them, or denying them opportunities, or instead favoring others for opportunities. Sometimes discrimination can be easy to spot, such as when someone is excluded from a group of friends, but it is often disguised or excused as something else.

Discrimination isn't always deliberate, but it is still hurtful if it causes someone to feel excluded or judged.

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GOOD TO KNOW

If it happens to you

- Is there something about you, or who you are with, that has caused someone to treat you in this way?
- Talk to a parent, teacher, or tutor, as discrimination should be taken seriously.
- Feel positive about your identity, and don't let discrimination discourage you from reaching your full potential.

Types of discrimination

There are many different types of discrimination. Most types are directed at people who belong to certain groups, or who have particular backgrounds or lifestyles. Some people can be victims of more than one type of discrimination at a time.

Ableism happens when the needs of people who are in some way disabled fail to be accommodated by society.

Ageism refers to assumptions about a person because of their age. It works in both directions, young and old.

Class discrimination occurs when someone is treated unfairly because of where they grew up and whether they are rich or poor.

Heterosexism is the assumption that everyone is straight (heterosexual).

LGBTQ+ discrimination limits the opportunities of people because of their sexuality or gender.

Racism is the unfair treatment of a person or group because of their skin color, nationality, citizenship, or ethnicity.

Religious discrimination occurs when someone is poorly treated because of their beliefs or religion.

Sexism is the unfair treatment of another person because of their sex, and is usually directed toward women.